Ratzanyel Rincón

Iona Drive 6000
Vancouver, BC V6T 1L4
Canada

November, 2026
rrinconv@student.ubc.ca
ratzanyelrincon.github.io

Education

University of British Columbia (UBC) 2021-2027 (expected)
Ph.D. Candidate in Economics

El Colegio de México, A.C. (Colmex) 2016-2018
M.A. in Economics

Instituto Politécnico Nacional (IPN) 2011-2015
B.S. in Physics and Mathematics

Professional Experience

Banco de México 2018-2021
Economist, Directorate General of Economic Research

Fields of Research

Labour Economics, Applied Econometrics

Job Market Paper

Suppressing Paper Unions: Evidence from the USMCA's Labour Provisions in Mexico
with Ángel Espinoza and León Fernández Bujanda

Abstract: We study the effects of a major labour reform induced by the U.S.–Mexico–Canada Trade Agreement (USMCA) on Mexico's union system, which aimed to improve workers' wages and working conditions by eliminating *paper unions*—unions that exist only on paper, do not represent workers, and allow firms to forestall real unionization. The reform required existing collective bargaining agreements (CBAs) to be legitimized by workers through secret-ballot votes and introduced stricter requirements for signing new CBAs. As a result, 78% of pre-reform CBAs were terminated, with few new CBAs created subsequently. We combine the universe of pre-reform CBAs with matched employer–employee and survey data and employ a matched difference-in-differences design to estimate the effects on union firms. We find that the reform had a null effect on average wages, but employment and the wage bill at union firms increased by 3.6% and 3.1%, respectively, by 2026. Profits at union establishments in manufacturing also increased by 5.4% following the reform. To rationalize these findings, we develop a model of optimal firm sorting in which the reform reduces firms' marginal labour costs by eliminating payments to paper unions and weakens the union threat by raising the cost of unionization for workers.

Working Papers

Are Immigrants Particularly Entrepreneurial? Firm Ownership as a Key Element in Immigrant Income Assimilation
with David A. Green, Huju Liu, Yuri Ostrovsky, and Garnett Picot

Causal Inference with Groupwise Matching
with Kevin Song

Working Income Tax Benefits, Minimum Wage, and Employment Transitions of Low-Skilled Workers: Evidence From Canada

Work in Progress

Inside the Collective Agreement: Text, Linked Microdata, and the Economics of Union Bargaining
with Pierre-Loup Beauregard and João Galindo da Fonseca

Publications

Quarterly Multidimensional Poverty in Mexico Using Machine Learning Algorithms. *Estudios Económicos*, Vol. 38, No. 1, January, 2023, pp. 3-68. https://doi.org/10.24201/ee.v38i1.435

Grants and Awards

Stone Centre on Wealth and Income Inequality Ph.D. Fellowship, UBC	2024-present
Four Year Doctoral Fellowship, UBC	2022-2026
Center for Innovative Data in Economics, Research Grant, UBC	2024
Graduate Studies Fellowship, CONACyT Mexico	2016-2018
BBVA Academic Excellence Award, Colmex	2016 and 2017
Academic Excellence Award, IPN	2014 and 2015

Presentations

"The Effects of Suppressing Company Unions: Evidence from Mexico" presented at the 30th Annual Latin American and Caribbean Economic Association Meeting (November 2025)

"Quarterly Multidimensional Poverty in Mexico Using Machine Learning Algorithms" presented at PUED UNAM's seminar (June 2024) and the 24th Annual Latin American and Caribbean Economic Association Meeting (November 2019)

Research and Teaching Experience

Research Assistant to:

Prof. David Green, University of British Columbia	Fall 2023-present
Prof. Kevin Song, University of British Columbia	Spring 2023
Prof. Jaume García, Pompeu Fabra University	Summer 2017

Teaching Assistant: Introduction to Econometrics I (B.A. course, UBC). Econometric Methods (M.A. course, UBC). Mathematics for Economics (M.A. course, UBC). Statistics (M.A. course, Colmex). Game Theory (B.A. course, Colmex). Mathematics II (B.A. course, Colmex)

Language, Programming Skills, and Other

Spanish (native), English (fluent)
Proficient with R, Stata and Julia
Ph.D. Student Representative at Vancouver School of Economics, UBC 2024-2025
Volunteer at *Tutor en Internet MX* and *Aplicar Desde México*

References

David Green
Vancouver School of Economics
University of British Columbia
6000 Iona Drive
Vancouver, BC V6T 1L4, Canada
david.green@ubc.ca

Raffaele Saggio
Vancouver School of Economics
University of British Columbia
6000 Iona Drive
Vancouver, BC V6T 1L4, Canada
rsaggio@mail.ubc.ca

Thomas Lemieux
Vancouver School of Economics
University of British Columbia
6000 Iona Drive
Vancouver, BC V6T 1L4, Canada
thomas.lemieux@ubc.ca

Samuel Norris
Vancouver School of Economics
University of British Columbia
6000 Iona Drive
Vancouver, BC V6T 1L4, Canada
sam.norris@ubc.ca